

MOBILE HEURISTIC EVALUATION REPORT

IA: Instagram | Heuristic Benchmark: Amazon | Framework: Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics

RATING REFERENCE LEGEND

● Good (Strong compliance)

▲ Needs Improvement

■ Poor

Heuristic Breakdown & Comparative Analysis

1 Visibility of System Status	
Keep users informed about what is going on through appropriate feedback within a reasonable time.	
Instagram GOOD / STRONG Provides clear feedback with loading indicators, interactive stories progress indicators, and instantaneous real-time feed updates.	Amazon GOOD / STRONG Delivers highly clear search results, prominent delivery information layout, clear stock status alerts, and exact progress tracking dashboards.
2 Match Between System and the Real World	
Speak the user's language, with words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than system-oriented terms.	
Instagram GOOD / STRONG Uses familiar language, standard social networking icons, and highly relatable real-world metaphors (e.g., physical camera, heart for liking, and paper plane for direct messaging).	Amazon GOOD / STRONG Employs widely recognized transactional terms ("Add to Cart", "Buy Now", "Delivery"), universally standardized e-commerce icons, and a layout that mimics a real-world shopping flow.

3 User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake and need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without hassle.

Instagram

NEEDS IMPROVEMENT

Offers very limited undo options or recovery paths for critical user actions, such as accidentally deleting posts or wiping out direct messages.

Amazon

GOOD / STRONG

Features seamless post-purchase workflows including easy cancellations (return orders), quick cart edits, easy item removal, and the ability to modify delivery options dynamically.

4 Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform conventions.

Instagram

GOOD / STRONG

Strictly follows standard mobile UI design guidelines and social media industry standards for layout navigation and gestures/interactions.

Amazon

GOOD / STRONG

Adheres comprehensively to global e-commerce patterns and web standards that users have already built familiarity with across multiple platforms.

5 Error Prevention

Even better than good error messages is a careful design which prevents a problem from occurring in the first place.

Instagram

NEEDS IMPROVEMENT

Accidental double-tap likes or sending messages/requests to the wrong DMs can easily happen due to a lack of friction or confirmation steps.

Amazon

GOOD / STRONG

Explicitly confirms critical details before placing final orders, displays prominent interactive warnings for limited stock availability, and flags user eligibility issues actively.

6 Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another.

Instagram

GOOD / STRONG

Utilizes highly persistent bottom icons, explicit tab layouts, and contextual text suggestions to minimize cognitive memory load and keep system features discoverable.

Amazon

GOOD / STRONG

Provides robust live search suggestions, recent item search history lists, delivery addresses, and saved watchlists that remain easily accessible at all touchpoints.

